Theaters, while the Chinese box office provides a huge part of Hollywood's profits.[68] Negative portrayals of China are almost entirely absent from US movies, a far cry from dark portrayals of Nazis, Soviets, or rapacious Japanese businessmen in the past. Indeed, a remake in 2012 of the iconic 1980s film *Red Dawn* digitally changed the invading Chinese soldiers into North Koreans in post-production, to avoid offending Chinese sensibilities. Other plots that are never likely to appear in US movies include China's worldwide espionage operations, oppression of Tibet or the incarceration of a million Uighurs in far western Xinjiang in "reeducation camps," suppression of religion, its massive prison system, forced abortions, or its military challenge to US power in Asia. Instead, Chinese are often portrayed as magnanimous statesmen, as in the 2016 science fiction thriller *Arrival*, where the wisdom of a Chinese PLA general prevents a global war. Just as noticeably, when trailers for the sequel to Tom Cruise's 1986 smash hit *Top Gun* were released in the summer of 2019, observant fans noticed that Japanese and Taiwanese flag patches had been replaced on Cruise's character's flight jacket. It was subsequently reported that the Chinese internet conglomerate Tencent helped cofinance the movie, sparking charges of Chinese demands to remove the offending patches or that producer Paramount Pictures self-censored to avoid fallout with Chinese audiences that could hurt ticket sales.[69]

These benign messages sent out on college campuses and by Hollywood undoubtedly help serve broader national purposes. They dovetail perfectly with Chinese president Xi Jinping's global PR push and bolster the attractiveness of bold Chinese plans like the One Belt One Road initiative, eliding questions about the risks of doing business with China, and dampening worries in the United States about China becoming a strategic competitor. Taken together, the new China rules are designed to sweep aside opposition to Beijing's preferred policies, to marginalize and discredit criticism of China, and to portray China's rise as inexorable.

In some ways, Beijing is merely doing what all nations do—namely, promote its interests. Yet no country can compare to China's size and